PART III · EXPRESSION · 5

Ornaments
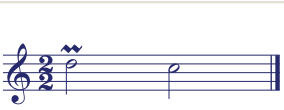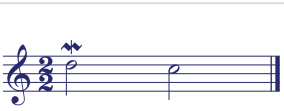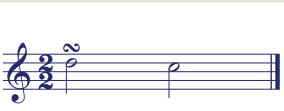
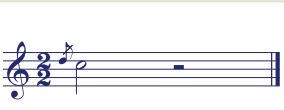
Ornaments are decorations: a small sign that stands for a quick burst of notes around the main note. They borrow the notes **next door**, one letter name up or down: on D, the note above is E and the note below is C.

THE SECRET

An ornament is a necklace on the note: it borrows the next-door notes, and the main note still lands on time.
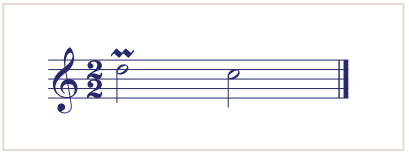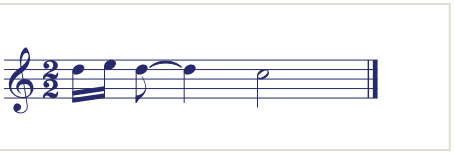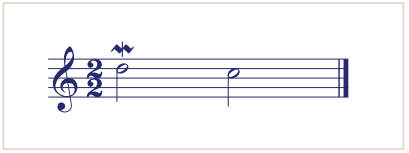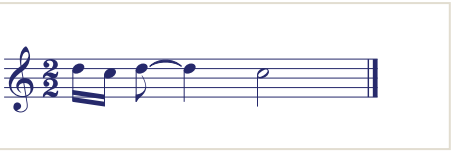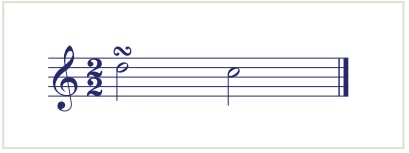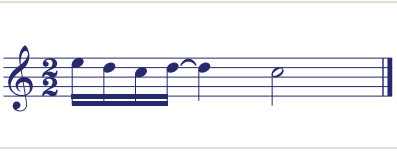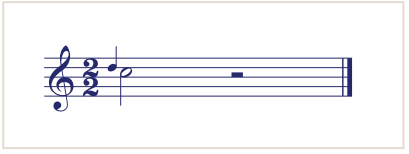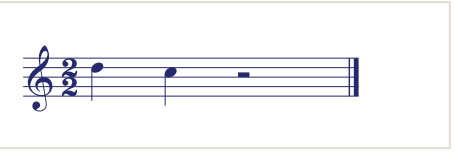


A small sign, a burst of notes

WRITTEN	NAME	HOW TO PLAY
	**trill**	the note and the one above, back and forth quickly
	**upper mordent**	the note, the one above, the note: one quick flick
	**lower mordent**	the note, the one below, the note
	**turn**	above, the note, below, the note
	**acciaccatura**	a tiny note with a slash: crushed in, as fast as you can
	**appoggiatura**	a tiny note, no slash: leans, taking half the main note's time

PART III · EXPRESSION · 5 · CONTINUED

Written and played

	WRITTEN		PLAYED
upper mordent		→	
lower mordent		→	
turn		→	
appoggiatura		→	

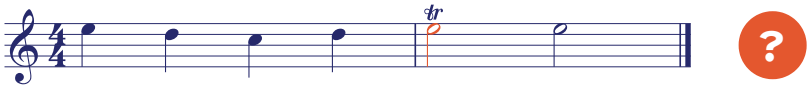
EXTRA · GOING FURTHER

Where does a trill start?

In music from the 1700s (Bach, Handel), a trill usually starts on the note **above**: F E F E on an E. In later music it starts on the main note. Your teacher or the edition will tell you.

EXAMPLE 1

How do you play this trill?



?

1. **Which note** has the tr?
2. **Its next-door note above** is...?
3. **Go back and forth** for how long?

On the E: **E F E F...** quickly for its two beats, then the last E on time.

GAME

Above or below?

1	2	3	4
trill	upper mordent	lower mordent	turn

Which next-door note does each one use: above, below, or both?

Answer: 1 above · 2 above · 3 below · 4 both.

PART III · EXPRESSION · 5 · CONTINUED

EXAMPLE 2

Crushed, or leaning?
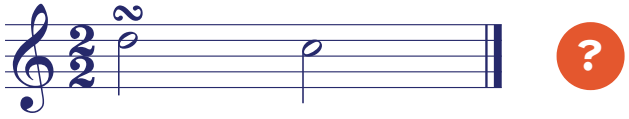


1. **Look for the slash** through the tiny note.
2. **With a slash:** how fast?
3. **Without:** how much time does it take?

Slash (acciaccatura): **crushed in**, almost at once. No slash (appoggiatura): **D for a crotchet**, then C.

EXAMPLE 3

Which notes does the turn use?



1. **The main note** is D.
2. **Next door above**, and **next door below**?
3. **Order:** above, main, below, main.

E D C D, then hold the D: four quick notes, ending on the main note.

TRY IT · 10 SECONDS



A slow trill.

Play D and E with fingers 2 and 3, slowly, eight times. Then a little faster. A trill is just that, at speed, with the beat still steady.

HOW TO

Practise an ornament

1. **Play the main notes** alone first, in time.
2. **Add the ornament slowly**, as written-out notes.
3. **Speed it up** bit by bit, keeping the main note on the beat.

TRAP

- × Adding a sharp or flat that is not there: use the plain next-door letter.
- × Starting the ornament late: it begins on the beat (a crushed note just before it).

SEE ALSO

The keyboard p. 22 · Sharps and flats p. 35

PRACTISE IT

Online: Library › Ornaments